

Printing Solutions

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Smart SoHo

We take a look at the surveillance technology which allows you to keep a watch over your home or office over the internet

State of the Web

To gain insights into the Indian domain market, the upcoming brand new TLDs, and its impact on us, we spoke with BigRock and PIR (Public Information Registry). Excerpts from our interview:

Jayesh Shinde

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What are your thoughts on domain registration in the country?

Shashank: Directi Group (a parent organization of BigRock) has a fairly large number of domain names not only in India but globally, and here are some interesting research findings. India has over 100 million people online. The total number of domain names registered by registrants from India is anywhere between 3 to 4 million, which effectively gives you the domain name to the internet user ratio, which is about 3.5 to 4 percent. That number is pretty low compared to other countries like Germany which has the ratio of 36 to 40 percent, which statistically means that out of every 100 internet users there are 35 to 40 domain names registered within that country. Countries like Turkey are at 75 percent, while China has 5 to 6 percent. The point I'm trying to make is many of these countries are ahead of us in these domain name to internet user ratio. But the fundamental belief given the increase in number of online users and number of businesses, individuals or organisation looking to establish an online presence, the Indian figures are only going to exceed. And they're doing it pretty rapidly.

Google India has a target of putting up 1 million Indian businesses online by the end of 2012. Do you think that's feasible? What are your expectations?

Shashank: For Google, a large part of their business comes from the ability to drive search traffic, keyword advertisements, etc., and that's their traditional mainstay in India and across the world. I'm familiar with the Google program you mentioned,

about their goal and ambition. The number isn't unimaginable, however, it is hard to get there. For instance, Google launched their program last year and recently they sent out an update stating they have reached 50,000 users in the program.

There are about 10 million small and medium businesses in India who are IT addressable of which only 0.5 million actually have websites, close to 5 percent, which is a very low number. We're all doing our bit to boost this number. A lot of us (those in the domain registration business) are attacking the market from various sides.



Shashank Mehrotra,
Business Head, BigRock

Among domains registered through BigRock, what is the split between individuals and businesses?

Shashank: It's a fairly even split. We track this on a monthly basis, and again these are self-reported numbers. We do make our customers tell us which category they fit in and we analyse our user base, and they're fairly evenly

placed between registrants who categorise themselves as individuals and those who categorise themselves as a company or organization. In terms of percentage, the split is around 50-50.

What's the big deal about .ORG domain and why are you focusing on it now?

Brian: India's a very important market in terms of selling .org domains. The .org domain is a very well known brand and it is very trusted domain, that's one of its brand attributes. Traditionally people look at .org domain for non-commercial



Brian Cute, CEO, PIR

organisation and to some extent it is true. By partnering with BigRock, we are projecting the brand attributes of .org to a broader Indian audience, not just non-commercial organisations but also companies and small businesses. What we are trying to say is that if your company has the values reflected in the .org domain, from the way you

do your business and the way you treat your employees, so that .org is your home on the internet.

Can you talk a little about the upcoming TLDs and their online significance?

Brian: ICANN earlier published that it has space for at least 2100 new extensions in its system. These upcoming, new TLDs will be driven by big brands wanting to establish an address for their brand or company name (Google applying for .google domain, for e.g.). You will see geographically relevant domain names (gTLDs) coming up for prominent cities like .mumbai, .delhi, .london, .paris, things of that nature will be another segment. You will also see generic domains come up like .sports, .music, etc., that's a strong segment. And you'll also see community-based domain names - for e.g., we are applying for .ngo as a community-based TLD which is restricted only for registered non-governmental organizations. Expect these domains or similar kind of new TLDs to be available by this time next year. It's an exciting time ahead. 

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